



Fairchild Channel F

computer matches, a first in mainstream console history. There was also a hold button on the console, which allowed for changing the game speed, time or just freezing the game.

The controllers for the Channel F were a primitive version of today's joystick, with a large grip on top, that would be held and moved around for eight-way directional control. However, one of the biggest changes ushered in by the Channel F was the introduction of the Atari VCS a year later.

The year of 1977 was a busy one for the video game console industry, which was also what led to the industry crash in 1983, but more on that later.

One of the first consoles of that year was the Coleco Telstar, a series of consoles that focused on television tennis. In that sense, the Telstar was pretty similar to the Home Pong systems, but that was where all similarity ended. One unique feature of this console was the ability to control the difficulty of the game, by changing the size of the player paddles. The Telstar was able to achieve sales of more than \$1 million by introducing an ingenious marketing and manufacturing ploy: despite the ability of Telstar's General Instrument AY-3-8500 chip to allow for 6 games on the system with many